

THE SALARY SLIP THAT DIDN'T ADD UP

Recorded Conversations — Hemant Sharma

This document presents the key spoken conversations from Hemant Sharma's (Emp. ID GEN-AI-4471) salary dispute at NexGen Tech Solutions Pvt. Ltd., reconstructed in dialogue format for reference. Three scenes are included: the leave request conversation, the salary confrontation with his manager, and the follow-up meeting where the matter was resolved.

NexGen Tech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. — this is a fictional story created for illustrative purposes.

SCENE 1: The Leave Request

Talking: Hemant Sharma (Assistant Project Manager) and Rakesh Malhotra (Sr. Project Manager) — via WhatsApp/phone, Sunday, 12 January 2025, night

Hemant calls Rakesh shortly after emailing his leave application.

HEMANT SHARMA:

Sir, sorry for calling this late. I've just sent you a leave application — my father's been hospitalised in Lucknow. Cardiac episode. I need to leave first thing tomorrow.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Is he stable?

HEMANT SHARMA:

Yes sir, stable for now, but the doctors want a family member present for the procedures and paperwork.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Go. Don't worry about the sprint, I'll have Aryan cover the stand-ups. Just keep your phone on for anything critical.

HEMANT SHARMA:

Thank you, sir. I've requested the 13th to the 19th — five working days.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Approved. Take care of your father first.

Rakesh replies to the email minutes later: "Approved. Take care."

SCENE 2: The Salary Confrontation

Talking: Hemant Sharma and Rakesh Malhotra — Rakesh's cabin, Friday, 31 January 2025, afternoon

Hemant knocks on the glass door and enters. Rakesh gestures at the chair without looking up.

HEMANT SHARMA:

My salary is short by Rs. 12,300, sir.

Rakesh looks up, folds his hands on the desk, and nods slowly.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

I know. HR processed it as per policy.

HEMANT SHARMA:

But you approved my leave, sir. I have the email.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Approval of leave and salary treatment are two different things, Hemant.

HEMANT SHARMA:

Can you explain how seven days of approved leave results in a deduction of Rs. 12,300?

Rakesh swivels his monitor and pulls up a chart he has used in HR townhalls before.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Look at this. Your basic is Rs. 36,000. Divide by 26 working days — that's Rs. 1,384 per day.

Seven days of Leave on Pay — that's Rs. 9,692. Then Section 6.2 says the performance incentive is withheld if working days fall below 20. You had 17. So the Rs. 2,500 bonus was held back too.

Total: Rs. 12,192. Rounded with minor tax adjustments, that's your Rs. 12,300 gap.

HEMANT SHARMA:

Sir, just to be clear — my basic is Rs. 36,000, but my full monthly CTC is Rs. 72,000, and my usual take-home is around Rs. 61,500 after standard deductions. That's the number I'm comparing against. This month I only received Rs. 49,200.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Correct. The LOP and bonus deductions are calculated on basic salary only, as per Section 5.3(a) and 6.1 — not on your gross CTC or take-home. That's a common misunderstanding. The 26-day divisor formula always applies to basic pay.

HEMANT SHARMA:

But sir — I have casual leave balance. And I applied for only 7 days.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

You had 2 CL left. So 2 days were adjusted as CL. The remaining 5 were LOP because your earned leave balance was zero.

HEMANT SHARMA:

I was not told about this when I applied.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

That's why we have a policy document, Hemant. I'll give you a copy. Read it. If you believe there's an error in the application of any clause, come back to me with a written representation — and I'll escalate it to HR.

He slides a thick, spiral-bound policy document across the desk. Hemant picks it up — it is heavier than it looks.

SCENE 3: The Follow-Up Meeting

Talking: Hemant Sharma and Rakesh Malhotra — Rakesh's cabin, Monday, 3 February 2025, 9:30 AM

Hemant arrives with a manila folder: his representation letter, the hospital discharge summary, the leave approval email, the HRMS leave balance snapshot, and his highlighted copy of the policy.

HEMANT SHARMA:

Rakesh sir, I have read the policy.

Rakesh looks up — something shifts in his expression, not quite surprise, but close.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

All of it?

HEMANT SHARMA:

All eleven sections.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Good. Then you understand the deduction.

HEMANT SHARMA:

I understand how it was applied. But I believe Clause 6.2(e) entitles me to file a Bonus Exception Request for the Rs. 2,500 performance incentive — because my absence was caused by a documented family medical emergency. I have the hospital discharge summary from Medanta Lucknow, dated 15th January. I have your approval email from the 12th. I have the HRMS screenshot showing my leave balance before the leave — 2 CL available, 12.5 EL unused. Under Section 10.5, these are exactly the documents required.

Rakesh accepts the folder and scans through the pages with the practiced eye of someone who has read policy documents for years.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

The BER applies to bonus only. The LOP deduction stands — you had exhausted your CL and your EL wasn't requested for encashment at the time of application.

HEMANT SHARMA:

I understand. I'm not contesting the LOP, sir. It was correctly classified — I had 2 CL left, and the remaining 5 days had no paid leave to cover them. I accept that. What I am contesting is the performance bonus withholding under Section 6.2, invoking exception clause 6.2(e). I'm within the 7-working-day window. February 10th is the deadline.

Rakesh sets the folder down. A short silence — the kind that precedes a decision.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Submit the BER to HR today. I'll countersign the recommendation. The Rs. 2,500 will be credited in February payroll if HR approves.

HEMANT SHARMA:

Thank you, sir.

Hemant stands to leave. Rakesh's voice stops him at the door.

RAKESH MALHOTRA:

Hemant. Next time, request EL encashment at the time of the leave application. It's Section 9.1(c). Would've saved you all this.

HEMANT SHARMA:

I know now.

He walks out.

Outcome: HR upheld Hemant's Bonus Exception Request on 7 February 2025 (Ref. GRP-2025-0147). The withheld Rs. 2,500 performance incentive was credited on 28 February 2025.